

member_data.Rdata codebook

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Data on members of Congress

Title/file name: member_data.Rdata

Citations: Author-created data source (Devin Judge-Lord and Eleanor Neff Powell and Justin Grimmer 2025), including:

- year, chamber, and party from Lewis et al. (2022) via voteview.com (also available on dataverse)
- committee positions from Stewart and Woon (2017) and @unitedstates-project (2025)
- state population from U.S. Census Bureau (2019)

Variable names, descriptive labels, and values:

- “congress” = Congress [110-116]
- “chamber” = “House” or “Senate”
- “bioname” = name from voteview.com
- “first_year” = First year serving in Congress [1989:2020]
- “icpsr” = ICPSR id number from voteview.com
- “district_code” = District number [0:53]
- “state_abbrev” = State abbreviation
- “state” = State name
- “pop2010” = State population in 2010 [563,767:37,252,895]
- “committees” = Committee assignments
- “chair” = Committee chair [0 = no, 1 = yes]
- “ranking_minority” = Ranking minority [0 = no, 1 = yes]
- “majority” = Majority party [0 = no, 1 = yes]
- “presidents_party” = Same party as the president [0 = no, 1 = yes]
- “party” = Political party [“(D)” = Democrat, “(R)” = Republican, “(I)” = Independent]

```
load(here::here("data", "member_data.Rdata"))
```

```
dim(member_data)
```

```
[1] 3865  17
```

```
head(member_data)
```

	congress	chamber	bioname	first_year	icpsr
1	110	House	BONNER, Jr., Josiah Robins (Jo)	2003	20300
2	110	House	ROGERS, Mike Dennis	2003	20301
3	110	House	DAVIS, Artur	2003	20302
4	110	House	CRAMER, Robert E. (Bud), Jr.	1991	29100
5	110	House	EVERETT, Robert Terry	1993	29300
6	110	House	BACHUS, Spencer T., III	1993	29301

	district_code	state_abbrev	state	pop2010
1	1	AL	alabama	4780127
2	3	AL	alabama	4780127
3	7	AL	alabama	4780127
4	5	AL	alabama	4780127
5	2	AL	alabama	4780127
6	6	AL	alabama	4780127

	committees	chair
1	AGRICULTURE APPROPRIATIONS BUDGET SCIENCE STANDARDS OF OFFICIAL CONDUCT	0
2	AGRICULTURE ARMED SERVICES HOMELAND SECURITY	0
3	HOUSE ADMINISTRATION JUDICIARY WAYS VOTING IRREGULARITIES OF AUGUST 2	0
4	APPROPRIATIONS INTELLIGENCE	0
5	AGRICULTURE ARMED SERVICES INTELLIGENCE	0
6	FINANCIAL SERVICES	0

	ranking_minority	majority	presidents_party	party	nominate_dim1	nominate_dim2
1	0	0	1	(R)	0.367	0.513
2	0	0	1	(R)	0.379	0.377
3	0	1	0	(D)	-0.270	0.454
4	0	1	0	(D)	-0.132	0.612
5	0	0	1	(R)	0.414	0.528
6	1	0	1	(R)	0.387	0.228

```
member_data |> skimr::skim()
```

Table 1: Data summary

Name	member_data
Number of rows	3865
Number of columns	17
Column type frequency:	
character	6
numeric	11
Group variables	None

Variable type: character

skim_variable	n_missing	complete_rate	min	max	empty	n_unique	whitespace
chamber	0	1.00	5	6	0	2	0
bioname	0	1.00	7	42	0	1090	0
state_abbrev	0	1.00	2	2	0	56	0
state	12	1.00	4	20	0	52	0
committees	63	0.98	1	135	0	1241	0
party	0	1.00	3	3	0	3	0

Variable type: numeric

skim_variable	n_missing	complete_rate	mean	sd	p0	p25	p50	p75	p100	hist
congress	0	1	112.99	2.01	110.00	111.00	113.00	115.00	116.00	
first_year	0	1	2003.35	9.02	1989.00	1995.00	2005.00	2011.00	2020.00	
icpsr	0	1	24367.47	9232.95	1366.00	20518.00	21183.00	29375.00	99342.00	
district_code	0	1	8.18	10.25	0.00	1.00	5.00	11.00	53.00	
pop2010	12	1	121608481.36	72163573.76	767.00	25401.80	91936.00	80462337.00	252895.00	
chair	0	1	0.08	0.27	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	1.00	
ranking_minority	0	1	0.08	0.26	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	1.00	
majority	0	1	0.55	0.50	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	
presidents_part0	0	1	0.50	0.50	0.00	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.00	
nominate_dim1	12	1	0.05	0.44	-0.78	-0.37	0.12	0.46	0.93	
nominate_dim2	22	1	0.00	0.29	-0.99	-0.19	0.00	0.19	0.99	

References

- Devin Judge-Lord and Eleanor Neff Powell and Justin Grimmer. 2025. “Replication Data: The Effects of Shifting Priorities and Capacity on Elected Officials’ Policy Work and Constituency Service: Evidence from a Census of Legislator Requests to u.s. Federal Agencies.” Harvard Dataverse Network, at: <https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/LWOCW>.
- Lewis, Jeffrey B., Keith Poole, Howard Rosenthal, Adam Boche, Aaron Rudkin, and Luke Sonnet. 2022. “Voteview: Congressional Roll-Call Votes Database.” <https://voteview.com>. Date Accessed: Feb. 24, 2022.
- Stewart, Charles, III, and Jonathan Woon. 2017. “Congressional Committee Assignments, 103rd to 115th Congresses, 1993–2017: House of Representatives.” https://web.mit.edu/17.251/www/data_page.html#2. Date Accessed: March 18, 2025.
- @unitedstates-project, the. 2025. “Unitedstates/Congress-Legislators.” <https://unitedstates.github.io/> <https://github.com/unitedstates/congress-legislators>. Date Accessed: March 18, 2025.
- U.S. Census Bureau. 2019. “State Population Totals: 2010-2019.” <https://www.census.gov/data/datasets/time-series/demo/popest/2010s-state-total.html>. March 18, 2025.